

Pre-Flight Privacy Checklist

Advertising & Brand Content

Complete this checklist before every drone flight for high-production campaigns over public & private space.

Job Details

OPERATOR NAME

DATE OF SHOOT

SHOOT LOCATION / SITE

CLIENT / BRAND NAME

LICENCE / RPA REG NO.

WEATHER CONDITIONS

1 — Permits, Consent & Authorisation

- ☐ **CASA sub-regulatory authorisation obtained (if operating over people or in controlled airspace)**
ReOC or specific CASA approval confirmed in writing prior to the shoot.
- ☐ **Client / production company consent form signed**
Written brief confirms scope of aerial footage; privacy obligations acknowledged by client.
- ☐ **Location / land owner permission confirmed**
Written permit obtained from land owner or local council for the shoot site.
- ☐ **Third-party property owners notified**
Adjacent property owners informed of shoot dates, times and flight zone.
- ☐ **Public space notification completed (if applicable)**
Council permit obtained; signage erected at entry points to the shoot area.
- ☐ **Talent / subjects on-screen consent obtained**
All identifiable talent signed model release forms; extras briefed on drone filming.
- ☐ **Privacy Act obligations explained to production team**
Director, producer and crew aware footage may capture personal data of bystanders.

2 — No-Fly Zones & Airspace

- ☐ **Airspace checked via CASA tool (Airshare / OneSky)**
No restricted, prohibited or controlled airspace within planned flight area.
- ☐ **NOTAM reviewed for shoot date and time**
No active NOTAMs affecting the site.
- ☐ **Proximity to aerodromes confirmed**
5.5 km radius from controlled aerodromes checked; CASA authorisation obtained if required.
- ☐ **Flight within visual line of sight (VLOS) or BVLOS approval held**
VLOS maintained or BVLOS approval from CASA confirmed in writing.
- ☐ **Operating height at or below 120 m AGL (or approved altitude)**
Maximum planned altitude confirmed; any exemption documented.
- ☐ **Temporary flight restriction (TFR) or exclusion zone not required**
If TFR needed (e.g. major public event nearby), CASA application lodged and approved.

3 — Privacy Risk Assessment

- ☐ **Public / bystander presence mapped for each flight window**
Shoot schedule adjusted to minimise incidental capture of non-consenting members of public.
- ☐ **Flight path reviewed to avoid residential windows, courtyards and private spaces**
Camera angles and altitude set to prevent incidental capture of private property interiors.
- ☐ **Children present on set — additional safeguards applied**
Parental/guardian consent obtained; drone not flown directly over minors.
- ☐ **Crowd control / set security in place to manage public access**
Production assistants or security managing perimeter to prevent unauthorised entry to flight zone.
- ☐ **Sensitive locations assessed (hospitals, schools, places of worship)**
Additional consideration given to operating near sensitive sites; community notification completed.
- ☐ **Competing brand or IP capture risk assessed**
Flight path reviewed to avoid capturing competitor signage or copyrighted material.

4 — Data Collection Limits

- ☐ **Footage scope limited to approved shot list**
Camera operator briefed; no speculative filming outside agreed production brief.
- ☐ **Bystander facial capture minimised; post-production blurring plan confirmed**
VFX or edit team briefed to blur identifiable non-consenting members of public.
- ☐ **Audio recording disclosed or disabled**
Onboard microphone off or all on-set personnel informed of audio capture.
- ☐ **Drone footage not used in final deliverable without privacy review**
All aerial footage reviewed by producer and privacy-checked before delivery to client.
- ☐ **Thermal, multispectral or enhanced sensors not deployed without justification**
Only standard RGB camera used unless additional consent and written justification obtained.

5 — Data Handling & Storage

- ☐ **SD card / storage media is blank before shoot**
No residual footage from previous productions on recording media.
- ☐ **Footage transferred to encrypted production storage within 24 hours**
AES-256 encrypted drive or approved cloud storage with access controls.
- ☐ **Retention and deletion schedule agreed with client**
Raw files deleted per production contract; schedule documented in writing.
- ☐ **Raw footage access restricted to authorised production personnel only**
Access log maintained; sharing with third parties (e.g. VFX house) requires written consent.
- ☐ **Footage not published or distributed without final privacy clearance**
No release to media, social platforms or broadcast without sign-off from producer and client.

6 — Equipment Pre-Flight Check

- ☐ **RPA registration / markings current and visible**
- ☐ **Battery charged at or above 80%; spare batteries checked**
- ☐ **Propellers inspected — no cracks or chips**
- ☐ **Return-to-home altitude set above tallest obstacle on location**
- ☐ **Gimbal and camera calibrated; ND filters fitted for shoot conditions**
- ☐ **Remote ID broadcasting confirmed (if required)**
- ☐ **Redundant communication link checked (if BVLOS operation)**
- ☐ **Safety observer / spotter briefed and in position**

7 — Post-Flight Actions

- ☐ **Footage reviewed for unintended personal data capture**
Flag any footage of identifiable non-consenting persons; log for blurring or deletion.
- ☐ **Incident log updated if any privacy issue arose**
Record complaints, near-misses or unplanned captures; escalate to producer if required.
- ☐ **Client provided with copy of this completed checklist**
Signed copy retained by operator for minimum 7 years.

Operator Sign-Off

By signing below I confirm all checklist items have been reviewed and completed to the best of my knowledge.

OPERATOR SIGNATURE

DRONE NAME